UNION PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

Civil Services (Preliminary Exam) - 2023

GENERAL STUDIES : PAPER-I

Time : 2 hours **(Exam date : 28.05.2023)** **Maximum Number : 200**

1. In which one of the following regions was Dhanyakataka, which flourished as a prominent Buddhist centre under the Mahasanghikas, located?
(a) Andhra (b) Gandhara (c) Kalinga (d) Magadha

Ans. (a) : Dhanyakataka also known as Dharaniketa is a town near Amaravati in the Guntur district of Andhra Pradesh was the capital city of the Satvahana Kingdom and it also flourished as a prominent Buddhist centre.

2. With reference to ancient India, consider the following statements :
1. The concept of Stupa is Buddhist in origin.
2. Stupa was generally a repository of relics.
3. Stupa was a votive and commemorative structure in Buddhist tradition.
How many of the statements given above are correct?
(a) Only one (b) Only two (c) All three (d) None

Ans. (b) : The term stupa comes from the Sanskrit Word stupa, which means heap or pile. Originally stupas were simple mounds of earth or stones that served as commemorative markers for important events or burial sites. The concept of stupa is not Buddhist in origin. Hence statement-1 is incorrect. One of the primary functions of stups is to serve as a repository of relics. Relics are objects associated with Buddha such as his physical remains personal belonging or items used by him. Hence statement-II is correct.
Stupas are also associated with votive and commemorative purposes. Stupas are often built as acts of devotion and as offerings to the Buddha or others enlightened beings.
Hence statement III is also correct.

3. With reference to ancient South India, Korkai, Poompuhar and Muchiri were well known as.
(a) capital cities
(b) ports
(c) centres of iron-and-steel making
(d) shrines of Jain Tirthankaras

Ans. (b) : Korkai, poompuhar (also known as Ka Veripattinam) and Muchiri are ancient port cities in the southern region of present day Tamil Nadu India.

4. Which one of the following explains the practice of 'Vattakirutal' as mentioned in Sangam poems?
(a) Kings employing women bodyguards
(b) Learned persons assembling in royal courts to discuss religious and philosophical matters
(c) Young girls keeping watch over agricultural fields and driving away birds and animals
(d) A king defeated in a battle committing ritual suicide by starving himself to death

Ans. (d) : Vatakkiruttas, also known as Vadakiruttal was a Tamil ritual of fasting till death, during, sangam age widespreadly. The Tamil kings, in order to save their honour and prestige were prepared to meet thieve death after defeated in a battle.

5. Consider the following dynasties :
1. Hoysala 2. Gahadavala 3. Kakatiya 4. Yadava
How many of the above dynasties established their kingdoms in early eighth century AD?
(a) Only one (b) Only two (c) All three (d) None

Ans. (d) :

Dynasty		Establishment
Hoysala	–	Between 10th to 14th centuries.
Gahadavala	–	Between 11th to 13th centuries.
Kakatiya	–	Between 12th to 14th centuries.
Yadava	–	Between 12th to 14th centuries.

6. With reference to ancient Indian History, consider the following pairs :

	Literary work		Author
1.	Devichandragupta	:	Bilhana
2.	Hammira-Mahakavya	:	Nayachandra Suri
3.	Milinda-panho	:	Nagarjune
4.	Nitivakyamrita	:	Somadeva Suri

How many of the above pairs are correctly matched?
(a) Only one (b) Only two (c) Only three (d) All four

Ans. (c) :

Literary work		Author
Devichandragupta	–	Vishakha Deva
Hammira-Mahakavya	–	Nayachandra Suri
Milinda-panho	–	Nagarjune
Nitivakyamrita	–	Somadeva Suri

7. "Souls are not only the property of animal and plant life, but also of rocks, running water and many other natural objects not looked on as living by other religious sects."
The above statement reflects one of the core beliefs of which one of the following religious sects of ancient India?
(a) Buddhism (b) Jainism
(c) Shaivism (d) Vaishnavism

Ans. (b) : Jain religion believe in reincarnation which means the cycle of birth, and rebirth is determined by one's Karma. They also believe that plants animals and even some non-living things like air and water have souls, just as human do have.

8. Who among the following rulers of Vijayanagara Empire constructed a large dam across Tungabhadra River and a canal-cum-aqueduct several kilometres long from the river to the capital city?
(a) Devaraya 1 (b) Mallikarjuna
(c) Vira Vijaya (d) Virupaksha

Ans. (a) : Devaraya-1, the ruler of Vijaynagar empire credited for constructed a large dam across Tungabbadra river and commissioned a 24 km long aqueduct from the Tungabhadra river to the capital.

9. Who among the following rulers of medieval Gujarat surrendered Diu to Portuguese?
(a) Ahmad Shah (b) Mahmud Begarha
(c) Bahadur Shah (d) Muhammad Shah

Ans. (c) : Bahadur Shah of Gujarat surrendered Diu to Portuguese in 1534. Bahadur Shah during his conflict with the Mughal emperor Humayun, secured help from the Portuguese, and he signed the treaty of Bassein with the Portuguese by this, he ceded Diu to the Portuguese.

10. By which one of the following Acts was the Governor General of Bengal designated as the Governor General of India?
(a) The Regulating Act
(b) The Pitt's India Act
(c) The Charter Act of 1793
(d) The Charter Act of 1833

Ans. (d) : The Charter Act of 1833 renamed the position of the Governor-general of Bengal as the Governor-General of India. Lord William Bentinck became the first governor-general of India.

11. In essence, what does Due Process of Law' mean?
(a) The principle of natural justice
(b) The procedure established by law
(c) Fair application of law
(d) Equality before law

Ans. (c) : "Due process of law" refers to just, rational and fair treatment under the regular judicial proceedings, thus it means the fair application of law. It states that a person cannot be denied their life, liberty or property without adhering to required legal procedures and receiving the appropriate protections. The due process of law limits the power of the law and protects an individual's rights

12. Consider the following statements :
Statement-I : In India, prisons are managed by State Governments with their own rules and regulations for the day-to-day administration of prisons.
Statement II : In India, prisons are governed by the Prisons Act, 1894 which expressly kept the subject of prisons in the control of Provincial Governments.
Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements :
(a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II is the correct explanation for Statement-I.
(b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II is not the correct explanation for Statement-I.
(c) Statement-I is correct but Statement-II is incorrect.
(d) Statement-I is incorrect but Statement-II is correct.

Ans. (a) : The Prison Act 1894 is one of the oldest part of legislation in India under Person Act, 1894 prisons are managed by State Governments with their own rules and regulation for the day-to-day administration of prisons. The Section-IV of prisons act 1894 clearly mentions. Prison mean any jail or place used permanently or temporarily under the general or special orders of a state governments for detention of prisoners. Hence both (A) and (R) is correct and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

13. Which one of the following statements best reflects the Chief purpose of the 'Constitution' of a country?
(a) In determines the objective for the making of necessary laws.
(b) It enables the creation of political offices and a government.
(c) It defines and limits the powers of government.
(d) It secures social justice, social equality and social security.

Ans. (c) : Function of a constitution is to set some limits on the functions of the government and what a government can impose on it's Citizens in terms of rights. These limits are fundamental in the sense that the government may never trespass them.

14. In India, which one of the following Constitutional Amendments was widely believed to be enacted to overcome the judicial interpretations of the Fundamental Rights?
(a) 1st Amendment (b) 42nd Amendment
(c) 44th Amendment (d) 86th Amendment

Ans. (a) : The first Amendment Act, 1951, added the Fourth clause to Article 15 that empowered the government to make any law for the upliftment of socially and educationally backward classes of citizens or for the scheduled castes and scheduled Tribes.
The need to insert this clause was felt after the decision of the Supreme Court in the Champakam Dorairajan case 1951. The Court gave literal interpretation to the constitutional provisions and held that reserving seats in public institutions for backward classes violates Article 15(1) and Article 29(2). Therefore, inorder to nullify the effect of similar judicial pronouncements, Article 15 was amended.

15. Consider the following organizations/bodies in India :
1. The National Commission for Backward Classes
2. The National Human Rights Commission
3. The National Law Commission
4. The National Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission
How many of the above are constitutional bodies?
(a) Only one (b) Only two (c) All three (d) All four

Ans. (a) : In the given options, the National Commission for backward classes (NCBC) is a constitutional body under Article 338(B) While the National Humans rights commission and the National Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission are statutory body under protection of Human Rights Act, 1993, and Consumer Protection Act, 1986 respectively. The National Law Commission is neither Constitutional nor statutory body. Hence only one pair is correctly matched.

16. Consider the following statements :
1. If the election of the President of India is declared void by the Supreme Court of India, all acts done by him/her in the performance of duties of his/her office of President before the date of decision become invalid.
2. Election for the post of the President of India can be postponed on the ground that some Legislative Assemblies have been dissolved and elections are yet to take place.
3. When a Bill is presented to the President of India, the Constitution prescribes time limits within which he/she has to declare his/her assent.
How many of the above statements are correct?
(a) Only one (b) Only two (c) All three (d) None